



Humanitarian Efforts to the Gaza Strip - Updated to September 25, 2025

Executive Summary

- Israel is fully committed to international humanitarian law, and has taken unprecedented measures to fulfill its legal obligations in accordance with the applicable norms, and to mitigate harm to the civilian population, while facing significant operational challenges
- As of today, the situation in the Gaza Strip remains governed by the **Laws of Armed Conflict**, which require the parties to a conflict to **allow and facilitate** access to humanitarian aid necessary to the population, including setting technical arrangements to ensure it is not **diverted from its civilian destination or misused for military purposes**.
- **Hamas continues to exercise control in the most densely populated areas of the Gaza Strip and still possesses significant governmental capabilities**. It seeks to reestablish control in areas where the IDF has operated.
- 48 hostages still remain in Hamas captivity. Those who are still alive endure brutal, unimaginable conditions including deliberate starvation, torture, and psychological abuse.
- **From the earliest days of the war and under the directive of the political echelon, the IDF has allowed and facilitated humanitarian efforts in the Gaza Strip, in compliance with Israel's obligations under International Humanitarian Law.**
- In a complex reality, shaped by an **ongoing armed conflict against brutal terrorist organizations**, Israel goes **beyond its legal obligations**, at times assuming significant security risks, to offer further assistance to facilitate the delivery of humanitarian aid across the Gaza Strip, **developing effective solutions in close and continuous cooperation with international partners**.
- In recent months, in accordance with the political echelon's directives and following a situational assessment, the IDF has initiated further **actions to significantly increase the scale of humanitarian aid entering the Gaza Strip**.
- Since the beginning of the war, **there have been no quantitative limitations on humanitarian aid to the Gaza Strip**. The entry of aid was temporarily suspended immediately after the October 7 attacks and again following the collapse of the ceasefire (between March 2, 2025 and May 19, 2025), in order to rearrange the humanitarian aid distribution system, based on assessments indicating the existence of sufficient food stocks, and continuous monitoring of the humanitarian situation.
- The monitoring and assessment of the humanitarian situation in the Gaza Strip and the needs of its population are based, *inter alia*, on collection of data regarding aid entry, **dialogue with various international organizations**, open-source publications on food and fuel stocks, as well as intelligence sources. Such data is **regularly reviewed, evaluated and presented to the political echelon**.
- During the suspension of aid following the collapse of the ceasefire, **the political echelon decided to implement structural reforms in the mechanisms of aid distribution, in order to mitigate diversion and misuse of aid by terrorist organizations, which seek to maximize civilian harm, for financial or military gain and population control**.
- Israel's humanitarian policy is subject to **continuous judicial oversight by the Israeli Supreme Court**, which is statutorily empowered to adjudicate State actions even in war time.



Humanitarian Efforts throughout the War

- Israel's commitment to comply with international law is reflected in the substantial **increase in humanitarian aid that has entered the Gaza Strip during intense hostilities**, including food supplies, medical equipment, means of shelter, and other supplies essential for the survival of the civilian population.
- Parties to a conflict are obliged to **allow and facilitate** the provision of humanitarian aid and supplies essential for the survival of the civilian population in a conflict zone (and not to provide it themselves). According to Article 23 of the Fourth Geneva Convention and Article 70 of the First Additional Protocol to the Geneva Conventions (both, in principle, reflect customary international law), a belligerent party may set **conditions to ensure that there are no serious reasons to fear that consignments will be diverted from their civilian destination or otherwise accrue to the advantage of the enemy's military efforts**. Israel goes beyond these obligations.
- Israel continues to work in **cooperation with international actors**, international organizations,¹ third States, and NGOs² in order to address the humanitarian needs of Gaza's civilian population. These humanitarian efforts continue to be implemented largely by the Coordination of Government Activities in the Territories (COGAT).
- COGAT officers and UN representatives have held regular situation assessment meetings on a daily basis to review ongoing efforts, assess ground conditions, and coordinate upcoming operations.
- According to COGAT, since the beginning of the war and until September 25, 2025, 108,709 trucks of aid have entered the Gaza Strip, 13,209 pallets have been airdropped and 9,710 tons of aid have entered through maritime route (amounting to additional 725 trucks). Foodstuff constituted 80% of all aid entering the Strip. Aid entrance is coordinated and prioritized by international organizations.
- During the most recent ceasefire agreement between January 19 and February 29, 2025, an unprecedented volume of humanitarian aid flowed into the Gaza Strip, dramatically surpassing previous levels. Throughout this period, Israel facilitated the entry of no less than 25,200 trucks carrying essential supplies. Israel's assessments indicated that this massive influx of aid **far exceeded Gaza's immediate civilian needs**, creating considerable reserves capable of addressing ongoing humanitarian requirements.
- **The monitoring and assessment of the humanitarian situation in the Gaza Strip and the needs of its population** are based, *inter alia*, on humanitarian aid data of aid

The UN agencies and aid missions coordinating with COGAT include the UN Children's Fund¹ ("UNICEF"), the UN Office for Project Services ("UNOPS"), the World Health Organization ("WHO"), the World Food Program ("WFP"), the UN Development Program ("UNDP"), the UN Population Fund ("UNFPA"), and the UN Department of Safety and Security ("UNDSS").

These NGOs include, among others, the International Medical Corps, the International Committee of the² Red Cross, Médecins Sans Frontières, WCK, Catholic Relief Services, UK-MED, Mercy Corps and Global Empowerment Mission.



entry, dialogue with various international organizations, information from Gazan civilians, open-source publications on food and fuel stocks and intelligence tools. This monitoring covers, in particular, the situation concerning food, water, medical treatment and supplies, sanitation, and fuel, and is **regularly reviewed, evaluated and presented to the political echelon.**

- The entry of aid was temporarily suspended following the collapse of the ceasefire (between March 2, 2025 and May 19, 2025), in order to rearrange the humanitarian aid distribution system, based on assessments indicating the existence of sufficient food stocks, and the continuous monitoring of the humanitarian situation.
- In accordance with instructions by the political echelon, a new humanitarian plan was established in order to **mitigate the ability of terrorist organizations in the Gaza Strip to take control or to profit from the distribution of humanitarian aid**, providing it directly to the civilian population. Israel has further facilitated the establishment of humanitarian distribution centers in the Gaza Strip, operated by the GHF, a US organization, which distributes food packages directly to households.
- On May 19, 2025, under the direction of the political echelon and based on the continuous assessment of the humanitarian situation, Israel reopened the crossings from its territory into the Gaza Strip for the passage of humanitarian goods. Since, and until September 25, 2025, 17,033 trucks entered Gaza through various land crossings, which amount to over 340,064 tons of aid, containing food, baby formula, medical equipment and supplies. 3,774 of these trucks (which amount to 17%) supplied the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation (GHF) and the distribution centers; 13,259 trucks contained aid delivered by the UN and other international organizations. **To date, hundreds of trucks containing aid to be distributed by the UN remain uncollected on the Gaza side.**
- The Israeli Supreme Court continues to provide judicial oversight regarding Israel's humanitarian policy in the Gaza Strip. As part of these proceedings, the Government of Israel provided the Court with periodical updates regarding the humanitarian efforts and situation in the Gaza Strip. On March 27, 2025, the Court, sitting as the High Court of Justice, issued a judgement (presiding judge President Amit) on a petition concerning humanitarian assistance to the civilian population in Gaza during the war, which concluded that Israel has made genuine efforts to adhere to its humanitarian obligations. An additional petition was recently erased to the request of the petitioners, while the Court acknowledged the substantial change in circumstances during the period since it was submitted.

Increase of Humanitarian Efforts

- **Throughout the war Israel has continuously expanded its humanitarian efforts, even during complex military operations:**



- *Humanitarian aid is delivered to the Gaza Strip both through designated distribution and the UN aid mechanism.*
- *Aid enters through multiple crossings, including Kerem Shalom in the south, Zikim in the north, and Kissufim and Gate 96 in the central region.*
- *Inside the Gaza Strip, Israel coordinates the movement of aid through multiple humanitarian corridors to facilitate its collection and distribution by the UN.*
- *Israel continues to coordinate humanitarian efforts within the Gaza Strip, including the repair of water infrastructure, medical evacuations, and other essential activities.*
- The vast majority of coordination requests made to COGAT by aid organizations, including hundreds by the UN, have been approved. Those that were rejected raised either security concerns, for example, excessive danger to the humanitarian mission due to nearby combat activity or concerns regarding the diversion of humanitarian.
- Due to **UN limited response**, and the assessment of the situation over the last weeks, Israel has taken significant additional steps to expand humanitarian operations, which has resulted in the increase of the daily average of aid entering the Gaza Strip to about **190 trucks per day and rising**.
 - The IDF has established sustainable **humanitarian corridors** to enable the safe passage and movement of UN convoys delivering aid to the civilian population, while taking into account operational constraints.
 - The IDF is implementing **daily humanitarian pauses** between 10:00 to 20:00 in densely populated areas, namely Al-Mawasi and Deir al-Balah. Civilians have been notified of these pauses in advance to maximize their effectiveness.
 - Considering the expansion of ground operations in Gaza City, on September 6, 2025, the IDF announced the establishment of a designated humanitarian area in Al-Mawasi, set up to facilitate the humanitarian response. This area hosts field hospitals, water pipelines, and desalination facilities.
 - On July 26, 2025, the IDF resumed **airdrops of humanitarian aid**, which include pallets of flour, sugar and canned foods to be provided to the population by international organizations. As of September 25, 2025, 2,759 pallets have been airdropped,³ amounting to circa 611 tons of food.
 - Resumption of **entry of fuel for humanitarian use** in coordination with the UN and based on an assessment of its fuel needs. By September 25, 2025, 230 tankers of fuel entered the Gaza Strip. The entry of fuel is subject to a monitoring mechanism agreed upon between Israel and the UN, which includes escort,

By Egypt, Jordan, the UAE, Germany, Belgium, France, the Netherlands, Canada and Spain. Israel has also ³ been working with Cyprus in order to continue the operation of a maritime route, which provides aid to the Gaza Strip from Cyprus via the Israeli Port of Ashdod.



inspection, supervision, and authorization by Israel of the humanitarian entities receiving the fuel.

- By September 25, 2025, over 13,700 tons of sheltered materials entered the Gaza Strip, along with over 3,400 tons of mixed aid supplies.
- **Entry of spare parts for trucks** to increase the number of operational trucks in the Strip and enable more **efficient aid collection**. Only on August 4, 2025, 25 trucks carrying spare parts entered the Gaza Strip.
- Supported by increased aid delivery, bakeries and community kitchen have been reopened, over 5,500 tons of baby formula and nutrition supplies in larger quantities entered Gaza.
- Since May 19, 2025, over 580 tons of water entered the Gaza Strip through various land crossings, in addition to two pipelines supplying water directly from Israel. COGAT has also coordinated and facilitated the refueling of water wells, the primary source of water that is accessible to the civilian population throughout the Gaza Strip, when required. The reconnection of an Israeli powerline to the desalination plant in Gaza is expected to provide approximately 20,000 daily cubic meters of water, serving about 900,000 civilians.
- Under the direction and approval of the political echelon, the UAE recently concluded its initiative to construct a water pipeline from the desalination plant in Egypt to the Al-Mawasi area along the coastline. This pipeline serves about 600,000 civilians, supplying daily 15 liters of water per person, in addition to the existing local water wells and Israeli water pipelines. Ongoing maintenance of Israeli water pipelines is supported by the IDF, insofar as operational constraints allow.
- As part of the efforts to expand humanitarian efforts in southern Gaza, which include the support of essential infrastructure, the political echelon approved expanding the activity of the 'Kela' power line, to operate an additional desalination facility in Deir el-Balah. The required infrastructure work will commence in the upcoming days. Currently, the desalination facility in Deir el-Balah operates on a fuel under UN coordination and supplies daily 1,500 cubic meters of water (1.5 million liters). The 'Kela' power line allows the facility to supply daily 6,000 cubic meters of water (6 million liters) – which are 4 times the current amount.
- On August 4, 2025, COGAT announced the approval to reinstitute the mechanism allowing the **entry of goods into the Gaza Strip by the private sector**, despite security concerns and the risk of Hamas exploitation. Among the approved goods are basic foodstuff, baby formula, fruits and vegetables and hygiene products. This is meant to ensure **additional aid and a higher variety of food**, as well as to cover the gap between UN capacities and needs on the ground.



- Israel's efforts and the recent improvements to the humanitarian situation in the Gaza Strip have been **recognized by others, including Germany, the European Union, and the United States**. Nonetheless, still greater efforts are currently in progress.

Distribution Centers

- The IDF is not involved in the distribution of aid in the designated distribution centers or the selection of its beneficiaries. The IDF's role is limited to facilitating the humanitarian operation, including the entry of aid, providing perimeter security where necessary, and coordinating movement routes inside the Gaza Strip to allow the safe activities of the organizations which provide aid to such centers. The planning, management and distribution of aid within the centers are conducted by the Safe Reach Solutions (SRS), tasked with securing aid distribution, in accordance with humanitarian principles and independent operational control.
- Since the beginning of their operations, over 2.7 million relief packages in total were distributed across four distribution centers, which according to the GHF are equivalent to **165 million meals**.
- The construction of two humanitarian distribution centers in southern Gaza will be completed in the coming days. These centers will replace the Tel al-Sultan distribution center in the south of the Strip, improving the safety of distribution and the quality of the humanitarian response.
- **IDF's rules of engagement do not permit the use of lethal force near humanitarian centers or convoys**, except in situations involving a clear and immediate threat to life. Additionally, as part of the IDF's operational learning process, the IDF continues to improve the operational environment in the vicinity of humanitarian centers by installing fences and signage, and opening additional access routes, which is already proving effective.
- Israel takes all allegations of civilian harm in the vicinity of distribution centers seriously and refers them to the competent IDF authorities. **Claims of misconduct are being examined by IDF's examination mechanisms and addressed accordingly.**

Humanitarian Medical Efforts

- Between May 19 and September 25, 2025, over 4,500 tons of medical equipment required for the operation of various medical facilities have entered the Gaza Strip. This includes the operation of 18 permanent facilities, while repairs are on the way in order to reopen additional such facilities, and 12 field hospitals.
- Recently, COGAT has also been coordinating with NGOs and the UN on the process for reopening the European Hospital. This hospital was used by Hamas as part of its military operations, and as mentioned above, Mohammad Sinwar, the head of Hamas's military wing at the time, was targeted while in a Hamas tunnel under this hospital.



- Israel, through COGAT, has established a **medical evacuation mechanism for Gazan patients in serious medical condition who require further treatment outside the Gaza Strip**. This mechanism enables transfer to third countries willing to provide such care, subject to security screening. Exits from Gaza are conducted via the Kerem Shalom crossing, with onward evacuation to third countries through either Ramon Airport or the Allenby Bridge.
- Since the beginning of the war, approximately 38,000 Gazans have exited to third countries – most of them patients and their escorts. Since the implementation of this mechanism through Kerem Shalom, over 4,000 Gazans – primarily patients and their escorts – have exited the Gaza Strip via Israel to third countries.⁴ Currently, the majority of the requests are granted and evacuations of between dozens and hundreds of Gazans occur weekly.
- **Israel imposes no limitation on the number of patients or escorts eligible for evacuation.** The scope of evacuations depends solely on the initiative and capacity of the international community. Notably, the majority of patients evacuated are children. Israel urges countries to accept patients for treatment.
- Countries that have facilitated medical evacuations to date include the United Arab Emirates, Jordan, Egypt, the United States, and numerous EU member states such as France, Italy, Spain, Germany, the United Kingdom, the Netherlands, Romania and Norway.

Dismantling Hamas Terrorist Infrastructure and Securing the Release of the Hostages

- Hamas has rejected many offers of ceasefire, put forward by the United States and other international mediators, demonstrating that it has no intention of ending the war or freeing the hostages.
- On August 8, 2025, Israel's Security Cabinet directed the IDF to prepare for taking control over Gaza City, while distributing humanitarian assistance to the civilian population outside the combat zones. The Cabinet adopted principles for concluding the war, which include the disarming of Hamas; the return of all the hostages – living and deceased; the demilitarization of the Gaza Strip; Israeli security control in Gaza; the establishment of an alternative civil administration.
- The IDF estimates that about 8-10 living hostages are held in Gaza City.
- The expansion of ground operations in Gaza City is meant to dismantle the Gaza City Brigade, which command and control capabilities have significantly recovered over the past year, and the network of tunnels concentrated in the west of the city that have been restored.

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- Hamas is imbedded in main civilian infrastructures in Gaza City, including hospitals, namely Shifa Hospital, hoping to take advantage both of their protected status and Israeli efforts to evacuate the civilian population from active hostilities.
- Israel remains fully committed to international humanitarian law, and will continue to abide by the humanitarian obligations applicable to it.

Hamas's Efforts to Undermine Israel's Actions

- Hamas and other terrorist organizations, **assimilated and embedded in the civilian population, loot humanitarian aid to strengthen their military and economic capabilities and to further their control over the population.** Hamas either hoards the consignments for its own use or resales it at greatly inflated prices. The proceeds from this profiteering directly fund Hamas, bankrolling salaries and the arsenals used against Israel and, all too often, against Palestinian civilians.
- Hamas commandeers humanitarian supplies intended for civilians in several ways: (1) Hamas directly captures and diverts trucks carrying humanitarian aid; (2) it offers “security services” to aid organizations, ostensibly protecting them from looting in exchange for portions of the humanitarian supplies; (3) Hamas manages aid distribution in shelters where its operatives maintain *de facto* control over civilians. In these facilities, Hamas’s operatives control aid distribution and prioritize supplies for themselves and their families at the expense of others.
- **Hamas militants deliberately pose as civilians** and do not wear uniforms or any other identifying markers indicating their affiliation. By having its militants **masquerade as humanitarian workers, Hamas systematically puts humanitarian operations at grave risk.** In one recent incident, Hamas operatives falsely presented themselves as World Central Kitchen (“WCK”) personnel, wearing the organization’s yellow vests and using a WCK-branded vehicle while carrying visible weapons.
- **Hamas has actively sought to undermine humanitarian efforts in the Gaza Strip,** including those led by the GHF, by intimidation of civilians seeking aid, abduction and killing of aid workers, and even a targeted attack near a GHF logistics hub. Such actions endanger humanitarian personnel and beneficiaries and obstruct the delivery of critical aid to the civilian population. Israel remains committed to enabling humanitarian operations and continues to take measures to protect and facilitate the efforts of international and local aid actors.
- Public demonstrations against Hamas have emerged in Gaza, reflecting deepening discontent with its sinister conduct.

NGOs' Registration

- In December 2024, the Government of Israel adopted Decision 2542, establishing a renewed registration system for NGOs, which includes a vetting process based on **transparent criteria and clear timelines.** This process enables an effective and



impartial registration process and **ensures no visas are issued to those engaged in support of terrorism or incitement to violence**. As part of this process, a long transition period has been granted to NGOs operating in the Gaza Strip.

- While various organizations have had no difficulty with this new mechanism, others have regrettably chosen not to cooperate with it, portraying it as obstructing their efforts while disregarding the fact that **Israel is entitled to guarantee its legitimate security interests**, and that the work of the NGOs is in fact **humanitarian and impartial**.

The Role of the UN

- UN agencies operating in the Gaza Strip are **not collecting** the hundreds of trucks cleared for distribution at the crossings, despite the significant efforts by the IDF to enable and facilitate their movement. Towards the end of July 2025, the efficient flow of 950 aid trucks into the Gaza Strip was therefore obstructed.
- Such agencies **do not fully acknowledge Hamas' harmful misuse of humanitarian aid and might turn a blind eye to its illicit behavior**. While UN agencies accepted Hamas escorts for their aid convoys, they refused similar arrangements with Israel, notwithstanding Resolution 2720 of the Security Council which acknowledged the diversion of aid from its intended recipients, preventing it from reaching the civilian population. They demonstrate a reluctance to work with Israel to expand and improve various humanitarian operations, declining to collaborate with the GHF, and creating **operational obstacles** to fulfilling a humanitarian imperative.
- The UN's rapportage regarding the situation in Gaza relies, often exclusively, on **unverified sources which repeatedly incorporate Hamas' claims**, without independently verifying them or voicing concerns regarding methodology, anomalies, or incomplete information, disregarding significant information published by Israel. Various States, including Germany, have called for particular caution in relying UN bodies' reports concerning Israel.

The Connection between UNRWA and Hamas in Gaza

- UNRWA in the Gaza Strip has been **deeply infiltrated by Hamas and other terrorist organizations operatives**. The presence of nearly 1,500 Hamas operatives, including from its military wing, in key positions in UNRWA (school principals, engineers, medical workers, finance, security, etc.) has enabled Hamas to exploit the agency's extensive infrastructure and resources for its terror activities against Israeli civilians and armed forces, particularly on and since October 7, 2023.
- **Hamas' systematic use of UNRWA facilities** as a cover for tunnels, weapons caches, command centers, rocket launchers and attack positions were meticulously planned and prepared years before the current war.
- UNRWA continues to demonstrate an egregious **lack of neutrality and impartiality**, despite Israel's prior notice to the UN. UNRWA, through statements by its



Commissioner General reveals clear bias and deliberate advancement of a partisan political agenda.

Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) Famine Review Committee (FRC) Report

- On August 22, 2025, the IPC issued yet another **methodologically flawed and deficient** report whose predetermined conclusions are based on selective and manipulative data. Previous IPC reports on Gaza warned of “imminent” catastrophes which ultimately never materialized.
- In its latest report on Gaza, the IPC **manipulated its own rules and standards** in order to declare famine without meeting the established criteria, in an exceptional and politically charged classification.⁵ The IPC used a lower famine threshold, relying on flawed data and analysis, while either downplaying or disregarding information that would undermine its **politically motivated conclusions**. For example, the IPC made no mention of the drop of food prices in Gaza during August, and neglected to address such criticism. Based on factual and statistical manipulations, the IPC speculated that the numbers of unreported deaths related to malnutrition crossed the famine threshold. These speculated numbers are over thirty times higher than even the malnutrition-related deaths reported by Hamas.
- The IPC was established two decades ago to provide scientific assessments of food insecurity during conflicts, based on universally recognized criteria. The IPC is required to follow a multi-stakeholder approach and ensure full transparency of its analysis process, in order to mitigate the risk of bias and politicization. However, when it comes to the Gaza Strip, the IPC abandoned its core principles, failing to engage with Israel apply its stated commitment to transparency.

Conclusions

- The current reality in the Gaza Strip is a **direct consequence of the murderous assault launched by Hamas on October 7, 2023**, to which Israel has responded in order to protect its citizens, secure the release of all the hostages, dismantle the military and governance apparatus of Hamas and other terrorist groups, and ensure Gaza Strip will not pose a threat to Israel. **It has both the right and obligation to do so.**
- Israel has made **extraordinary efforts to address the current humanitarian situation in the Gaza Strip**, during an ongoing armed conflict. The context is challenging, not least due to Hamas’s strategy to disrupt humanitarian efforts and divert aid in order to support its war against Israel and lay the blame for civilian suffering upon Israel.

An updated analysis of the IPC's methodological flaws is available on this web page:⁵
<https://govextra.gov.il/mda/ipc/gaza/>.



- Israel **continuously monitors the humanitarian situation** in the Gaza Strip in order to minimize civilian harm. In its continued efforts to facilitate humanitarian assistance, Israel continues to cooperate with the UN, third States, NGOs, and private parties in order to bring aid into the Gaza Strip to the benefit of its civilians.
- Israel remains firm in its determination to protect its territory and its people from incessant attack from Gaza, as it must, while **abiding by its legal obligations and in accordance with international law**. It has taken **extraordinary steps to minimize harm to the civilian population that are unprecedented in urban warfare**.